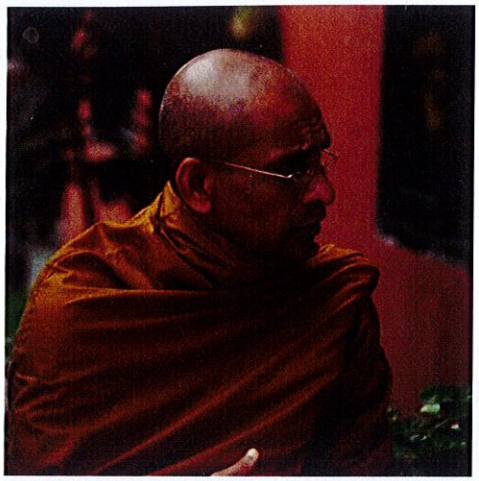
Echo of Aryans.....



In the grand tapestry of human history, there are civilizations that have left an indelible mark on our collective consciousness. Among these ancient societies, the Iranian civilization stands as a testament to the enduring spirit of humanity's quest for knowledge, wisdom, and understanding. It is with great joy and reverence that we extend a heartfelt invitation to join us, the researchers at the Al Musthapa University in Colombo 01, Sri Lanka, as we embark on a remarkable journey to explore the echoes of the Aryans.

The Echo of Aryans Initiative is a celebration of unity, a bridge between the ancient Iranian civilization and the vibrant culture of Sri Lanka. It is a sacred endeavor to connect the threads of our shared spirituality, transcending the boundaries that divide us and embracing the beauty of our diverse perspectives. This initiative seeks to foster mutual respect, cooperation, and dialogue, as we delve into the depths of our shared humanity.

As we gather in this enchanting event, we will begin with a warm welcome and introduction, setting the stage for a profound exploration of both Iranian and Sri Lankan heritage. Together, we will embark on a collective initiation, guided by the echoes of the Aryans, to embrace the power of unity and compassion. It is through this shared experience that we hope to discover common ground and celebrate the richness of our unique cultures.

Following the gathering, we invite you to indulge in a delightful insight, a feast for the senses that showcases the flavors from various cultures of the Iranian heritage. Just as the garden of humanity is diverse, with its vast range of colors and scents, so too is the array of experiences that await us in this momentous occasion.

Your esteemed presence at this live dialogue is of great significance, as it adds to the symphony of voices seeking understanding and harmony across civilizations. Together, let us honor the echoes of the Aryans and create a lasting legacy of friendship, enlightenment, and unity.

Welcome to the Echo of Aryans Initiative, where the ancient and the contemporary converge, and where the spirit of Iran and Sri Lanka intertwines to forge a brighter future for all.

Venerable Kalupahana Piyarathana Thero
serves as the convener of the Sangha for a Better Sri Lanka, an organization that works towards promoting social harmony and peace in the country.He served as member of the human right council of srilanka

A new world order from the echoes of the Aryans...



The word 'Aryan' is used to describe a group of people who spoke Indo-European languages and who were thought to have settled in prehistoric times in ancient Iran and the northern Indian subcontinent. The theory of an "Aryan race" appeared in the mid-19th century and remained prevalent until the mid-20th century. Since the late 20th century, a growing number of scholars use the term Aryan as a racial designation, suggesting that the Sanskrit term arya ("noble" or "distinguished"), the linguistic root of the word, was actually a social rather than an ethnic epithet. Rather, the term is used strictly in a linguistic sense, in recognition of the influence that the language of the ancient northern migrants had on the development of the Indo-European languages of South Asia.

The Mahavamsa's narrative of Sri Lanka's colonization includes historical detail—the settlers were Indo-Aryan people from northern India. The precise origin of the early immigrants is a matter of discussion, though, as evidence from the stories points to both the northeastern and northwest regions of the Indo-Gangetic Plain. The forefathers of Vijaya were from the northeastern state of Bengal, but his father later settled in Gujarat, which is in northwest India and is where the adventurers were sent out to sea.

However, scholars even today discuss the origin and settlements of the Aryan clan. This new research showcases that the relationship between the Sri Lankan and Iranian cultures were significant. The early merchants from Persia visited Thambapanni (Sri Lanka) from the 6th century. They came for gems and spices. The research provides evidence of Persian architectural influence in the complex engravings of Anuradhapura Kingdom.

Iran and Sri Lanka both had enormous history behind them with the guidance of the Aryan clan and the echoes of that past will showcase in the present also as we were gathering on this event. The two countries should tie their hands together to establish strong friendship among them to stand tall in today's rather complex world. These events, researches are invaluable for the task. We should seek this bond not only for physical but meantime for spiritual development too. It's time for these vibrant, intellectual two cultures to bend in the echoes of Aryans to bring happiness, peace across the world.

The tallest building in the world even started from one brick. A new world order will initiate from the echoes of the Aryans. As a writer and a translator I look forward in optimistic ways about this Echo Aryan initiative. I would like to pay my gratitude and give a heartfelt wish to all the scholars and other people who are gathering on this special day.

Rashmika Mandawala
Writer, Translator, Lecturer

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ECHO OF THE ARYANS



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1. Craddle of the civilization

The fertile cresant

Iran, known historically as Persia, holds a significant place as one of the cradles of human civilization on Earth. Its ancient history spans thousands of years and has witnessed the rise and fall of numerous empires and cultures. Let's delve into the rich and diverse history of ancient Iran

Prehistoric Period

Human presence on the Iranian plateau can be traced back to around 100,000 BC. Archaeological evidence suggests that early humans inhabited the region during the Middle Paleolithic period, leaving behind stone tools and cultural remains.

The Zagros Mountains in western Iran were home to early agricultural communities, such as Chogha Golan and Chogha Bonut, around 10,000 BC. These settlements represent the transition from hunter-gatherer societies to sedentary farming communities.

The Fertile Crescent region in southwestern Iran played a crucial role in the development of agriculture. Settled communities like Susa and Chogha Mish emerged around 6800 BC, cultivating crops and domesticating animals.

Protohistoric Period

The Jiroft culture, flourishing in southeastern Iran during the 4th millennium BC, is known for its distinctive engravings, objects made from various materials, and the world's earliest inscription. The Jiroft civilization had a complex social and economic structure.

Elam, centered off the Iranian plateau, emerged as a state around 4000 BC. It had close connections with Mesopotamian culture and engaged in trade and diplomacy with neighboring civilizations. The Proto-Elamite script, used by the Elamites, remains undeciphered, and records from Sumer pertaining to Elam are scarce.



2. Elamits republics old scripts

The Persian script and cultural heritage of Sumerian clay tablets have had a significant impact on Persian art and culture. While the Sumerians themselves did not use the Persian script, their clay tablets and the cuneiform writing system have played a crucial role in the development of writing and literature in the Persian-speaking world.

1. Influence on Writing

The cuneiform script used on Sumerian clay tablets was one of the earliest writing systems in the world. Its development and use by the Sumerians influenced the development of writing systems in neighboring regions, including Persia. The Persian script, known as the Old Persian cuneiform, was derived from the cuneiform script used by the Sumerians [[1]](https://www.worldhistory.org/-cuneiform/). This script was used to write Old Persian, an ancient Iranian language spoken in Persia during the Achaemenid Empire (550-330 BCE).

2. Literary Heritage

The Sumerian clay tablets contain a wealth of literary works, including myths, epics, and hymns. One of the most famous literary works discovered on Sumerian clay tablets is the Epic of Gilgamesh. This epic has had a profound influence on Persian literature, particularly in the genre of epic poetry. Persian poets and writers have drawn inspiration from the themes and narrative structure of the Epic of Gilgamesh [[1]](https://www.worldhistory.org/cuneiform/).

3. Cultural Exchange

The cultural exchange between the Sumerians and Persians extended beyond writing and literature. The Sumerians were known for their advanced agricultural techniques, architecture, and religious practices. These cultural elements, as seen in the Sumerian clay tablets, have influenced Persian art, architecture, and religious traditions. For example, the ziggurats, which were monumental stepped structures built by the Sumerians, have similarities with Persian architectural forms such as the Achaemenid palaces and the Sassanian fire temples [[1]](https://www.worldhistory.org/cuneiform/).

4. Sacred Feminine

The Sumerian clay tablets also provide insights into the role of women in ancient Mesopotamian society. The Sumerians had a pantheon of gods and goddesses, and female deities held significant positions. The goddess Inanna, for example, was associated with love, fertility, and war. The concept of the sacred feminine, represented by goddesses, has been an important theme in Persian art and culture. Persian poetry often celebrates the divine feminine and explores themes of love, beauty, and spirituality [[1]](https://www.worldhistory.org/cuneiform/).

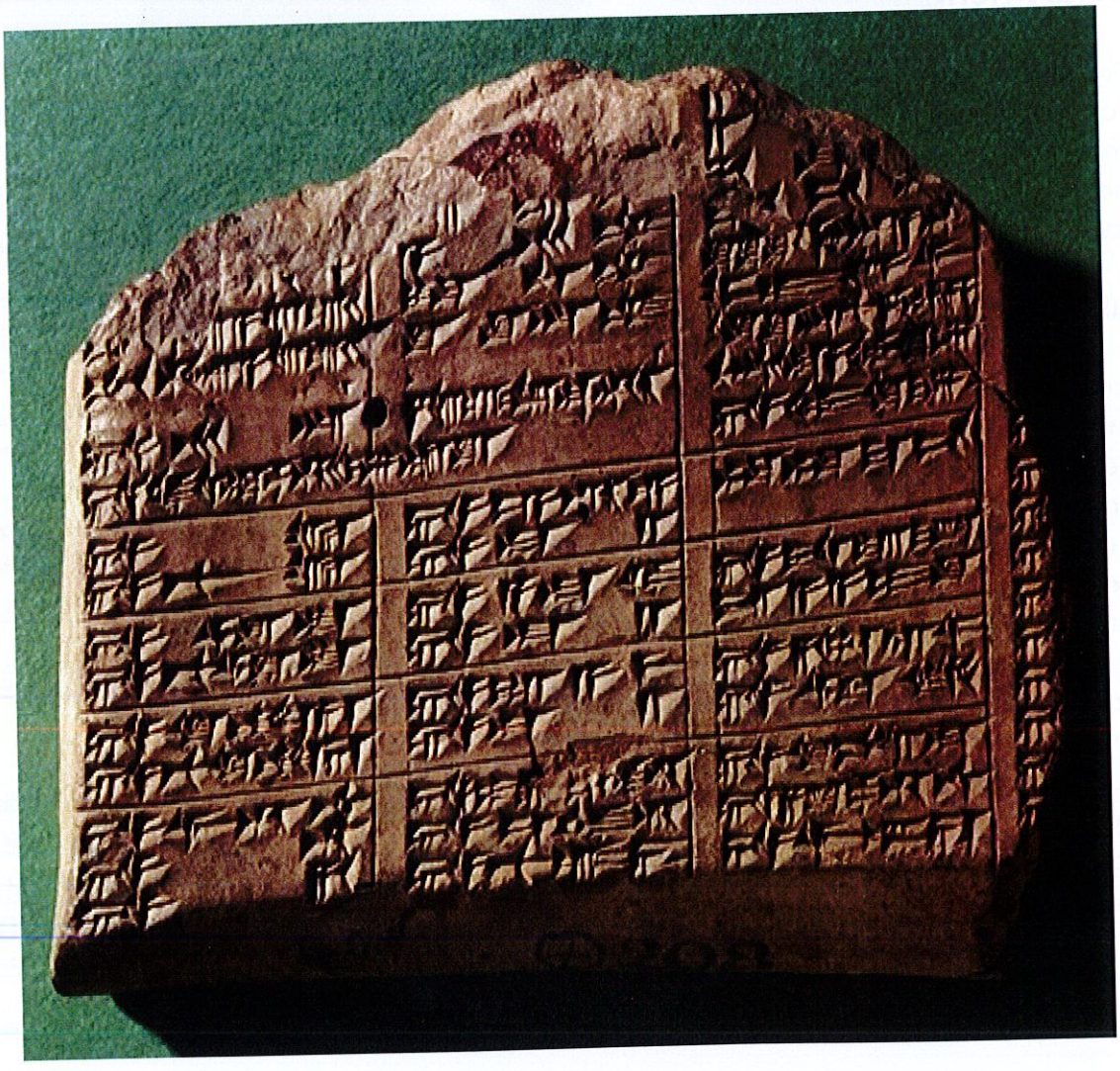
The Persian script and cultural heritage of Sumerian clay tablets have had a profound influence on Persian art, literature, and cultural traditions. The cuneiform script used by the Sumerians served as a foundation for the development of the Persian script, and the literary works found on Sumerian clay tablets have inspired Persian literature. Additionally, the cultural exchange between the Sumerians and Persians has influenced Persian architecture and religious practices, including the concept of the sacred feminine.

Learn more

1. [Cuneiform - World History Encyclopedia](https://www.worldhistory.org/cuneiform/)

2. [Old Persian cuneiform - Wikipedia](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Old_Persian_cuneiform)

3. [Sumerian Tablets: A Deeper Understanding of the Oldest Known Written Language | Ancient Origins](https://www.ancient-origins.net/artifacts-ancient-writings/sumerian-tablets-0011895)



3. Greater Persian Empire

Achaemenid Dynasty

The Achaemenid Empire, founded by Cyrus the Great in the 6th century BC, marked a significant period in Iranian history. It became the dominant power in the ancient world.

The Achaemenid Empire spanned from the Balkans to North Africa and Central Asia, making it the largest empire of its time. It encompassed diverse cultures, languages, and religions.

The Achaemenids were known for their architectural achievements. They constructed magnificent cities, palaces, and monumental structures. Persepolis, the capital city of the empire, stands as a testament to their architectural prowess.

The empire's official language was Old Persian, and they used cuneiform script for writing. The Achaemenids left behind an extensive corpus of inscriptions that provide valuable insights into their governance, religion, and cultural practices.

Iran's ancient civilization has made significant contributions to various fields

Weaving

Persian carpets and textiles are renowned for their intricate designs and craftsmanship.

Construction

The architectural marvels of ancient Iran, including Persepolis and the ruins of ancient cities, showcase advanced engineering and construction techniques.

Bread making

Iran has a long history of bread-making traditions, with various types of bread being prepared using unique recipes and techniques.

Winemaking

The tradition of winemaking in Iran dates back thousands of years, with evidence of vine cultivation and wine production found in ancient archaeological sites.

Cloth painting

Persian textile art, such as the intricate designs of silk and cotton fabrics, reflects the mastery of ancient Iranian artisans.

Scripts

Iran has been a hub of script development, with ancient writing systems like cuneiform and the later development of scripts such as Pahlavi, Avestan, and Persian.

The ancient civilization of Iran, with its rich cultural heritage, has left an indelible mark on human history. Its contributions to art, architecture, language, and various other fields continue to inspire and captivate people around the world.



Elamite Script and the Civilization of Elam in Iran

The Elamite script and the civilization of Elam in Iran are intricately connected, as the Elamites were an ancient civilization that thrived in what is now southwestern Iran. The Elamite script played a significant role in their society and is a crucial aspect of understanding their history and culture.

The Elamites were among the oldest civilizations in present-day Iran, emerging around 2600 BC and flourishing until 330 BC [1]. Their civilization was centered around the city of Susa, situated on the edge of the Mesopotamian plain and the Iranian plateau. The Elamites engaged in extensive trade with Mesopotamian kingdoms to the west and the Indus River civilization to the east [1]. Their cultural and political influence laid the foundation for subsequent Persian dynasties, including the Achaemenid Empire.

The Elamite script is an ancient writing system used by the Elamites, divided into two main periods: Proto-Elamite and Linear Elamite.

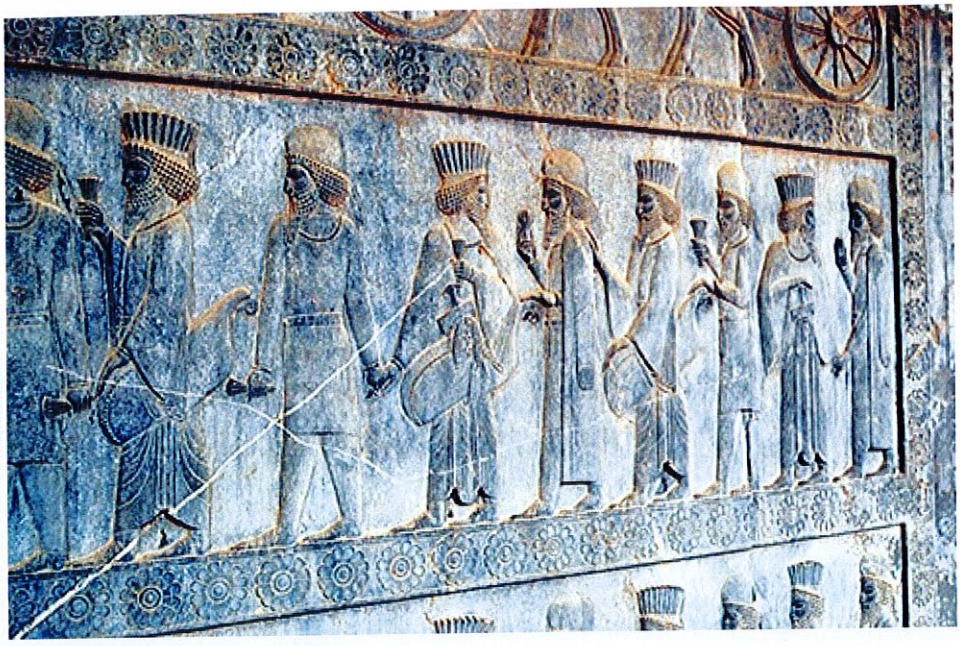
Proto-Elamite is recognized as the oldest writing system in the region of present-day Iran. It was an Early Bronze Age script that was briefly in use before the introduction of Elamite cuneiform

Linear Elamite

Linear Elamite is a later script that evolved from Proto-Elamite. It is a relatively obscure writing system used in what is now Iran. Linear Elamite inscriptions have been found scattered across Iran, though only a limited number of them have been unearthed

Deciphering the Elamite Script

Deciphering the Elamite script has posed a significant challenge for scholars. However, recent research led by French archaeologist Francois Desset has made notable progress in deciphering Linear Elamite. Desset and his team utilized newly examined inscriptions from ancient silver beakers to propose a method for reading the symbols of Linear Elamite. Their analysis has enabled them to decipher 72 Linear Elamite symbols, which account for over 96 percent of those known.



Significance and Implications

The decipherment of the Elamite script, particularly Linear Elamite, holds the potential to illuminate a relatively obscure society that existed between ancient Mesopotamia and the Indus River Valley. It offers valuable insights into the history, culture, and language of the Elamites. Furthermore, the decipherment has implications for the evolution of writing itself, as Linear Elamite is believed to be an innovative script that relies solely on syllables, akin to the later creation of the alphabet

The Elamite script and the civilization of Elam in Iran are intertwined aspects of ancient history. The decipherment of the Elamite script, especially Linear Elamite, provides a window into the enigmatic world of the Elamites, shedding light on their language, culture, and interactions with neighboring civilizations. Ongoing research and further decipherment efforts will contribute to a deeper understanding of the Elamite civilization and its place in the broader context of ancient Iran.

Elamite language In Persian mythology are Manu and Yama, who play a pivotal role in the creation myth and the origin of mankind. This exploration of Manu and Yama in Iranian myth and their contribution to the existence of humanity on Earth.

Manu and Yama in Persian Mythology

Manu and Yama hold a prominent place in Persian mythology, particularly within the context of the creation myth and the origin of mankind.

These twin figures are often depicted as divine beings with significant roles in the cosmic order and the establishment of human civilization.

The Creation Myth

The creation myth in Persian mythology features Manu and Yama as central figures in the process of the universe's formation and the emergence of humanity.

Manu, in this context, undertakes a sacrificial act involving Yama, which serves as a crucial event in the creation and organization of the world.

The Origin of Mankind

The sacrifice of Yama by Manu is believed to be instrumental in the birth and evolution of mankind.

From the remains of Yama, including his body parts, Manu creates the first human beings, symbolizing the connection between the divine and mortal realms.

Symbolism and Interpretations

Manu and Yama's mythological roles are often interpreted as representing essential functions within society and the cosmos.

Manu is associated with the priestly function, embodying the spiritual and ceremonial aspects of ancient Iranian civilization.

Yama, on the other hand, is sometimes seen as a primordial hermaphrodite, symbolizing the dual nature of creation and the interconnectedness of genders.

Cosmic Order and Social Organization

The myths surrounding Manu and Yama reflect the Persian priests' and kings' attempt to legitimize their roles in maintaining the cosmic order and societal organization.

The sacrificial act and the subsequent creation of mankind reinforce the importance of divine authority and the interconnectedness of the spiritual and earthly realms.

Manu and Yama hold significant positions in Persian mythology, particularly in the narrative of creation and the origin of mankind. Their roles as twin figures, the sacrificial act, and the subsequent birth of humanity are foundational elements in understanding the Persian cosmogony. By delving into these myths and their symbolic interpretations, we gain insights into the cultural, religious, and societal beliefs of ancient Persia.Origins, Evolution, and Presence of Varuna, Mithra, Anahita, and Ahura Mazda in Persian Art and Culture

Varuna, Mithra, Anahita, and Ahura Mazda are significant Iranian deities that have played a prominent role in Persian art and culture. These deities have ancient origins and have evolved over time within the Iranian religious and cultural context. In this document, we will explore their origins, evolution, and presence in Persian art and culture.

Varuna

Varuna is an ancient Iranian deity associated with the sky, water, and cosmic order.

In the early Iranian religion, Varuna was often paired with the god Mitra, forming the divine couple Mitra-Varuna.

Varuna was believed to be the guardian of cosmic order and the enforcer of moral law.

In Persian art, Varuna is depicted as a powerful deity associated with the sky and water elements

Mithra

Mithra is one of the most well-known and popular gods in the ancient Iranian pantheon.

Mithra is associated with the rising sun, contracts, covenants, friendship, and the orderly change of seasons.

Orderly change of seasons

He is often depicted as a warrior god, invoked by warriors before battle, and considered a protector of the faithful.

Mithra is linked to the Vedic god Mitra and is associated with the Roman Mystery Cult of Mithras.

In Persian art, Mithra is depicted riding a chariot, armed with weapons, symbolizing his role as a guardian of cosmic order and a protector against evil forces

Anahita

Anahita is a goddess of water, fertility, and wisdom in the ancient Iranian religion.
She is associated with rivers, lakes, and the life-giving properties of water.

Anahita is often depicted as a beautiful goddess, sometimes shown standing on a lion or riding a chariot.

She is revered as a mother goddess and a protector of women and children.

In Persian art, Anahita is depicted as a powerful and benevolent deity, often adorned with symbols of fertility and abundance

Ahura Mazda

Ahura Mazda is the supreme deity in Zoroastrianism, the monotheistic religion that emerged in ancient Persia.

Ahura Mazda represents the forces of good, light, and truth, and is associated with wisdom, justice, and cosmic order.

He is often depicted as a majestic figure, surrounded by symbols of power and authority.

Ahura Mazda is considered the creator of the universe and the ultimate source of all goodness.

In Persian art, Ahura Mazda is portrayed as a benevolent and wise deity, often depicted in a majestic and regal manner

Varuna, Mithra, Anahita, and Ahura Mazda have left a lasting impact on Persian art and culture. These ancient Iranian deities have evolved over time, reflecting the changing religious and cultural beliefs of the Iranian people. Their presence in Persian art serves as a testament to their significance and enduring legacy within Iranian society.While the archaeological evidence for Buddhism in Persia during Lord Buddha's lifetime is limited, there are some examples of findings that suggest the presence of Buddhism in the region . Here are a few examples



Similarities between ancient persian deity Mithra and Christ

The stories of Christ and Mithra are not just very similar Myths, they are the same allegorical yarn spun for the uninitiated since the dawn of civilization . Adaptations and mutations have occurred from time to time and culture to culture. The basic story however remains the same and evokes the same symbolism.

Birth of Jesus and Mithra both came of Virgin Birth

Adonis is another trans-cultural mutation of the Mithra Legend . Saint Jerome, the ecclesiastic who translated the original Latin of the Bible tells us that --"The death and resurrection of Adonis, the mythical savior of the Syrians, were observed in the very cave where the Christian savior was believed to have been born. " --The very same cave that most scholars believe Jesus was born in, {and that Christian Authorities are in agreement with} is the very same cave that Mithra was said to have been born in Centuries earlier.

As per Legend Three wise men from the East bought gifts of Gold, Frankincense and Myrrh at Jesus birth

As per Legend Three wise men from the East bought gifts of Gold, Frankincense and Myrrh at Mithras birth

Gold is the symbolic metal of the sun and was considered to be crystallized sunlight.

Frankincense was symbolic of Male Creativity.

Myrrh was symbolic of the goddess, and both Mary and Myrrha, are associated with Myrrh.

The Travels of Marco Polo diary tells the story related by Marco Polo about the Magi of Saveh, a town in Persia, who followed a strange star and visited the Holy Child [Jesus]

these wise men believed that they were visiting the reborn Mithra.

Jesus' Birth is celebrated between December 25 and January 6.

Mithras Birth is celebrated between December 25 and January 6.

According to biblical accounts. The only clue we have from the canonical scriptures of the New Testament as to the birthday of Christ is Luke 2:8 "Now there were in the same country shepherds living out in the fields, keeping watch over their flock by night." Shepherds did not live out in the fields in December , hence, Jesus Christ was probably not born in the winter on December 25. The December 25 date was inherited by Christianity and can be dated back to pre-mithraic and multi-cultural sources. Many ancient religions celebrated high holy days around December 25 through January 6 and it can usually be traced to a winter solstice . As the longest night of the year, December 21 is also a turning point, after which the days grow longer. In ancient times it

symbolized the triumph of the Sun God over the powers of darkness, so actually even though The birth of Mithra is celebrated at a time coinciding with the celebration of the Birth of The Jewish Christ, and the early Christians adapted this From Mithraism it is not necessarily the denotation of the birth of a personage, but the denotation of the re-birth in a sense of the Sun, while the Christians denote it as the birth of the Son.ized the triumph of the Sun God over the powers of darkness, so actually even though The birth of Mithra is celebrated at a time coinciding with the celebration of the Birth of The Jewish Christ, and the early Christians adapted this From Mithraism it is not necessarily the denotation of the birth of a personage, but the denotation of the re-birth in a sense of the Sun, while the Christians denote it as the birth of the Son.

Mithra's birth was celebrated on December 25th, by early pre-Christian Mithraists. But was originally celebrated in Iran on Dec. 21, the longest Night of the year.

"On this day also the Birthday of Christ was lately fixed at Rome in order that while the heathen were busy with their profane ceremonies, the Christians might perform their sacred rites undisturbed. They call this the Birthday of the Invincible One; but who is so invincible as the Lord? They call it the Birthday of the Solar Disk, but Christ is the Sun of Righteousness." 4th century Bishop John Chrysostom

The Apostles

Jesus had Twelve Disciples .
Mithra had twelve Disciples - symbolic of the Zodiac.

A major difference is the Twelve disciples of Jesus being Human, as opposed to being symbolic of Heavenly bodies in the case of Mithra .

The Zodiac and the Bible

Death and resurrection

Jesus resurrection is celebrated every year. on Easter, at which time he was resurrected.
Mithra resurrection was celebrated every year. His principal festival on what was later to become Easter.

Jesus and Mithra were both buried in a tomb and resurrected after three days

In both religions this is referred to as The Three days of Darkness.

Ceremonies and Symbolism

Catholics engage in a ritual Eucharist signed by a cross.
Mithraists engaged in a ritual Eucharist signed with a cross.

Catholics Celebrate a Mass in which they drink wine and eat bread to symbolize the body and blood of Jesus.

Mithraists Celebrated a Myazda in which they drank wine and ate bread to symbolize the body and blood of Mithra.

Purification through a ritualistic baptism was required of the faithful in both religions.

Jesus was identified with the Lamb & at times the Lion

Mithra was identified with the Lamb & at times the Lion

The Mithraic Holy father wore a red cap and garment and a ring, and carried a shepherd's staff

The Pope wears a red cap and garment and a ring and carries a shepherds staff.

Priests of Mithraism bore the Title father.

Catholic priests bear the Title Father - despite Jesus specific proscription of the acceptance of such a title

Matthew 23:9 "And do not call anyone on earth 'father,' for you have one Father, and he is in heaven."

The major traditions of The Original Christian Church of Rome, are little more than the Traditions of Mithraism, whose traditions date back to the ancient pre-Christian middle east and India.

Sun Symbolism

Jesus was identified as the SON of God - Mithra was a SUN God and is identified with SUN.

Mithra was a Sun-God / Solar Deity. An inscription in the Vatican states , "He who will not eat of my body, nor drink of my blood, so that he may be one with me and I with him, shall not be saved." This inscription is from the remains of the temple the Vatican was built over, a temple dedicated to Mithras.

Jesus is depicted with a Halo - Mithra is depicted with a Halo. Halo has synonymous meanings and relates to "The Light"
Both were referred to as "The light of the World."

Roman Emperor Constantine, who made Christianity legal throughout Rome, was a worshipper of Sol Invictus/ the invincible Sun. Sol Invictus is an amalgamation of trans-cultural solar deities including Mithras, and Apollo. Constantine recognized Jesus' status in that pantheon almost immediately. Many of the Stories of his life and activities are symbolic of celestial events.

In modern times, ancient solar symbols are plentiful in Christianity .

It is no mistake that when The Lady of Fatima gave a sign to the masses she chose the Sun. {Sun Dance}

When Constantine saw his Vision of "the cross superimposed on the sun". Was he seeing the Son superimposed on the Sun or The Son superimposed on the Sun

Solar cultures of Israel: The holy Kabbalah and secret symbolism

Jesus Christ, Sun of God: Ancient Cosmology and Early Christian Symbolism

Heaven and Hell

The worshippers of Mithras held strong beliefs in a celestial heaven and an infernal hell. They believed that the benevolent powers of the God would sympathize with their suffering and grant them the final justice of immortality and eternal salvation in the world to come. They looked forward to a final day of judgment in which the dead would resurrect, and to a final conflict that would destroy the existing order of all things to bring about the triumph of light over darkness. There is basically very little difference between the beliefs of the two systems, in respect to their concepts of Heaven, Hell and purgatory. Many of the Catholic and Orthodox beliefs, and legends that do not arise out of the Bible or Apocrypha have their roots in Mithraism and related Pagan belief systems.

The Apostles meet a Mithraist ?

In Mark 9:38 John said to Jesus "Teacher,.....we saw a man driving out demons in your name and we told him to stop, because he was not one of us." Who was this mystery man driving out Demons in the name of Jesus Christ ? He was not one of the Apostles, for they did not know him, and he is never mentioned in the Bible again, or if he was Paul and Genre censored it. This man driving out demons in The name of Jesus Christ was believed to be a follower of Tammuz or Mithra also known as Adonis OR a follower of an even more ancient religion from further East. He was invoking the name of Jesus Christ - as the Apostles understood it.

How is this possible ?

The name of Jesus was not yet known , there was no Christian Church yet, except for Jesus and the Twelve apostles - so how could a stranger be casting out Demons in the name of Jesus ? Is this passage a clue left by Mark in his Gospel, a clue missed by the Early Censors of Jesus ?

Jesus did not find this offensive as his reply to John was "Do not stop him," Jesus said, "for whoever is not against you is for you." This story is also related in Luke 9:40-50 and Mark 9: 37-39

He who will not eat of my body and drink of my blood, so that he will be made on with me and I with him, the same shall not know salvation." An inscription to Mithras which parallels John 6:53-54



3. Lord budhda and budhist tradition in Persia

Gandhara-style Buddhist Sculptures

The discovery of Gandhara-style Buddhist sculptures in various parts of Persia provides significant evidence of the influence of Buddhism in the region. These sculptures display distinctive features, such as the combination of Indian and Hellenistic artistic elements seen in the Gandhara art style. Examples of such sculptures have been found in regions including Bamiyan in Afghanistan and Kuh-e Khwaja in Iran.

Buddhist Monastic Complexes

Excavations have revealed the remains of Buddhist monastic complexes in Persia, indicating the existence of Buddhist communities. These complexes typically consist of structures such as monastic cells, meditation halls, stupas, and ritual spaces. One notable example is the Bahram Cave Monastery in Iran, which includes rock-cut chambers and Buddhist iconography.

Inscriptions and Epigraphs

Some inscriptions and epigraphs found in Persia make references to Buddhism or Buddhist concepts. These inscriptions, while relatively rare, provide further evidence of Buddhist presence in the region. For example, the Shahpur II inscription in Iran mentions the construction of a Buddhist monastery.

Several Buddhist artifacts, such as clay votive tablets and small figurines, have been discovered in Persia. These artifacts often depict Buddhist symbols, deities, or scenes from Buddhist narratives. They offer insights into the material culture and religious practices associated with Buddhism in the region.

It is important to note that these archaeological findings indicate the presence and influence of Buddhism in Persia at later periods, possibly after Lord Buddha's lifetime. These discoveries contribute to our understanding of the spread of Buddhism beyond its place of origin and the cultural exchange in ancient Persia. However, further research and investigation are necessary to gain a more comprehensive understanding of Buddhism in Persia during different historical periods.Lord Buddha's Persian connections.

Mahamaya Devi's Persian Royalty

According to certain claims, Mahamaya Devi, the mother of Prince Siddhartha (later known as Lord Buddha), hailed from Persian royalty. However, concrete evidence supporting this claim is currently lacking, necessitating further research to validate this theory. Exploring Mahamaya Devi's lineage and historical documents could shed light on this intriguing aspect of Lord Buddha's potential Persian heritage.

Persian Followers and Disciples

Lord Buddha's teachings attracted followers from diverse regions, including Persia. Claims suggest that two of his disciples, Thapassu and Balluka, were Persian traders. These claims indicate the presence of Persian followers during Lord Buddha's lifetime. However, the extent and influence of Persian culture and religion within the Buddhist community require further exploration and scholarly investigation.

Persian Region during Lord Buddha's Lifetime

To comprehend the social, ecological, and religious backdrop of the Persian region during Lord Buddha's lifetime, it is essential to consider the broader historical context. The Persian region, encompassing present-day Iran and surrounding areas, was influenced by various cultures and religions, including the ancient Iranian religion. It boasted a rich history, vibrant trade routes, and interactions with neighboring civilizations, all of which could have indirectly influenced Lord Buddha's teachings and the spread of Buddhism.



Siddhartha Gautama, the historical figure who became known as the Buddha, and the Achaemenid Persian Empire. The analysis is based on recent evidence, including family seals and records found at Persepolis, the ancient capital of Emperor Darius the Great. The presence of Gautama's name, along with his father Suddhodana Gautama, on these seals suggests a potential relationship between the Buddha and the Persian royal family. Additionally, inscriptions by Darius the Great referring to a usurper named "Gaumâta" raise the question of whether this figure could be Siddhartha Gautama himself. This document presents a comprehensive examination of the available evidence and explores the implications of such a connection on our understanding of the Buddha's origins and the influences on early Buddhism.

Introduction

- Background information on Siddhartha Gautama and the Achaemenid Persian Empire
- Significance of the potential link between the Buddha and Persia

Persepolis Seals and Gautama Family

- Description and interpretation of the Persepolis Seals
- Analysis of the family crest associated with the Gautama family
- Implications of the Gautama family crest being found in Persia

Inscriptions of Darius the Great

- Examination of the Bisutun Inscriptions and their references to "Gaumâta"
- Comparison between the description of "Gaumâta" and the qualities associated with Siddhartha Gautama
- The role of the Magi Order and Babylon's star observatory in relation to Gautama's poten tial involvement

Linguistic and Cultural Connections

- Analysis of the similarities between the names "Gaumâta" and Gautama
- Exploration of potential Mesopotamian influences on Buddhist scriptures
- Implications of discovering Babylonian influences on Buddhism

Assessing the Historical Narrative

- Darius the Great's propaganda campaign and its impact on historical accounts
- Evaluation of the assassination of "Gaumâta" and its potential implications
- Rebellions inspired by "Gaumâta" and Darius' suppression of dissent

The evidence linking Siddhartha Gautama and the Achaemenid Persian Empire

- Implications for our understanding of the Buddha's origins and the influences on early Buddhism
- Areas for further research and investigation

The purpose of this document is to present an objective analysis of the available evidence and explore the intriguing possibility of a connection between the Buddha and the Achaemenid Persian Empire. It is important to note that further research and scholarly scrutiny are necessary to establish the veracity of these claims and fully understand the extent of any potential links between the Buddha and ancient Persia.

The discovery and significance of a coin that is believed to be one of the earliest representations of the Buddha. The coin was found in the Jowzjan Province of present-day Afghanistan, within an archaeological site associated with an early Indo-Iranian settlement. Dated to the late 1st century BC or early 1st century AD, this aniconic gold coin offers valuable insights into the development of Buddhist iconography during this period. Unfortunately, the coin is presumed to have been destroyed or melted down by the Taliban in March 2001. This paper aims to shed light on the historical and cultural significance of this remarkable artifact.

The discovery of the first Buddhist coin in the Jowzjan Province of Afghanistan has brought forth intriguing insights into the early development of Buddhist iconography. This write-up delves into the historical context, archaeological findings, and the potential significance of this remarkable coin.

During the time of the Buddha, Buddhist representations were predominantly aniconic, devoid of direct depictions of the Buddha himself. Instead, symbols such as the Bodhi tree, footprints, or the wheel were used to represent the Buddha and his teachings. This aniconic tradition has been prevalent in Buddhist art for centuries.

Discovery and Archaeological Context

The gold coin was unearthed from a tomb attributed to a male warrior within an archaeological site in the Jowzjan Province. The site is believed to have been an early Indo-Iranian settlement, dating back to the beginning of the 1st century AD, or late 1st century BC.

Description of the Coin

The coin, now regrettably lost, was assumed to be one of the earliest representations of the Buddha. It is significant due to its departure from the aniconic tradition, potentially indicating an early stage in the development of Buddhist iconography. While precise details of the coin's design are not available, its existence hints at the emergence of anthropomorphic representations of the Buddha.

The discovery of the coin challenges the prevailing notion that anthropomorphic representations of the Buddha emerged much later in Buddhist art. If confirmed as an authentic representation, this coin would have pushed back the timeline for the development of iconic Buddhist imagery, providing crucial insights into the evolution of Buddhist art and its cultural significance

Tragically, the coin is presumed to have been destroyed or melted down by the Taliban in March 2001. The loss of this artifact is a profound blow to our understanding of early Buddhist iconography. However, the documentation and scholarly analysis conducted prior to its destruction have enabled us to glean valuable information about the coin's historical context and potential significance.

The discovery of the first Buddhist coin in the Jowzjan Province of Afghanistan offered a unique glimpse into the early stages of Buddhist iconography. Dated to the late 1st century BC or early 1st century AD, this aniconic gold coin suggested a departure from the prevailing aniconic tradition, potentially marking one of the earliest representations of the Buddha. The unfortunate destruction of the coin emphasizes the importance of preserving and documenting archaeological artifacts to further our understanding of ancient cultures and their artistic expressions.Admiral Zheng He's Presence in the Persian Gulf and Relationship with the Persian Empire.





Although concrete historical evidence confirming Lord Buddha's direct interactions with Persia is limited, the presence of claims and speculations regarding his Persian connections raises intriguing possibilities. Further research and exploration of historical documents, lineage records, and ancient texts are crucial to unraveling the truth behind Lord Buddha's potential Persian heritage. Understanding Lord Buddha's possible Persian connections contributes to our broader understanding of his teachings, the spread of Buddhism, and the cultural exchanges that shaped ancient civilizations.Nestorian Christian Settlement in Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka.

5. Nestorian Christians and their settlement in Anuradhapura Sri Lanka

Anuradhapura, located in present-day Sri Lanka, holds great historical significance as an ancient capital and a center of religious and cultural exchange. Among the diverse religious influences that shaped Anuradhapura's history, the presence of Nestorian Christianity stands out. This explores the historical context, evidence, and impact of the Nestorian Christian settlement in Anuradhapura.

Anuradhapura, once the political and religious capital of Sri Lanka, witnessed significant maritime trade and cultural interactions with various regions, including the Middle East. During the 5th to 10th centuries CE, the city flourished as a hub of international trade, attracting merchants, travelers, and religious communities from distant lands.

Nestorian Christianity, also known as the Church of the East, originated in Persia and spread along the Silk Road to the Far East. This branch of Christianity had a distinct theology and organizational structure. Nestorian Christians believed in the dual nature of Christ as both human and divine, and their ecclesiastical hierarchy extended across multiple regions.

Evidence of Nestorians'; One of the most significant pieces of evidence is the Nestorian Stele, discovered in Anuradhapura in 1913. The stele, inscribed in Syriac and Persian, records the visit of a Nestorian bishop named Mar Sapor to Sri Lanka in the 8th century. This inscription provides valuable information about the establishment of a Nestorian Christian community in Anuradhapura.

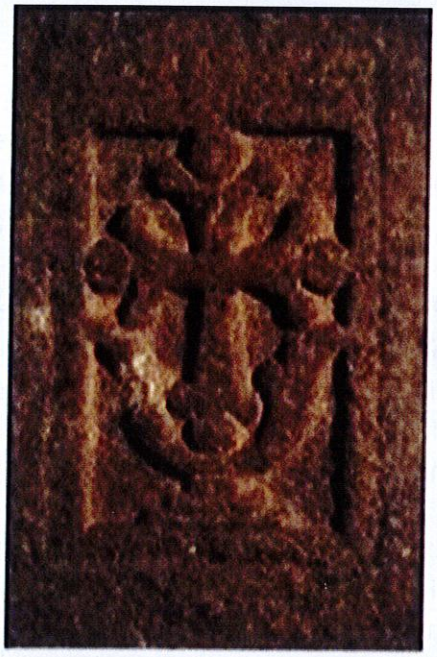
Excavations in Anuradhapura have unearthed artifacts such as pottery fragments, coins, and inscriptions bearing Nestorian symbols and motifs. These findings suggest the existence of a Nestorian Christian settlement and its integration into the local society.

Cultural and Religious Impact

The Nestorian Christian settlement in Anuradhapura had a profound cultural and religious impact on the city and its inhabitants. The exchange of ideas and beliefs between Nestorian Christians and the local population contributed to the religious diversity and cultural syncretism of the region. It fostered intellectual and artistic exchanges, influencing the development of local art, architecture, and literature.

The Nestorian Christian settlement in Anuradhapura represents an intriguing chapter in the city's history, highlighting its position as a vibrant center of cultural and religious exchange. The historical evidence, including the Nestorian Stele and archeological discoveries, confirms the presence of Nestorian Christianity in Anuradhapura during the 8th century. Understanding the Nestorian Christian settlement enriches our understanding of Anuradhapura's cosmopolitan nature and its role as a melting pot of diverse cultures and faiths.

Nestorian Christianity in Anuradhapura is an area of ongoing research, and further studies and investigations may provide additional insights into this fascinating historical phenomenon.





6. Persian presence in Srilanka in medieval times

Admiral Zheng He's voyages extended to the Persian Gulf and that he had interactions with the Persian Empire during his expeditions. Zheng He, being of Chinese Muslim origin and having connections with the Persian Sufi Muslim community, likely played a role in fostering relationships with Persian authorities. This paper aims to provide an overview of the evidence supporting Zheng He's presence in the Persian Gulf and his relationship with the Persian Empire, highlighting trade, diplomacy, political alliances, and cultural exchanges.

Documentation of Visits: Historical records, including the accounts of Ma Huan, a chronicler who accompanied Zheng He on his voyages, indicate that Zheng He's fleet visited several ports along the Persian Gulf, such as Hormuz, Qalhat, and Muscat. The Ming Dynasty's official records, such as the "Yongle Encyclopedia" and the "Ming Shilu" (Veritable Records of the Ming Dynasty), also document these visits.

Zheng He's expeditions aimed to promote trade and establish diplomatic relations with various regions. The Persian Gulf served as a crucial hub for trade routes connecting China with the Middle East, Africa, and Europe. Zheng He's fleet engaged in trade activities, exchanging Chinese goods for Persian commodities, and building economic ties with Persian merchants and authorities.

The presence of Zheng He's fleet in the Persian Gulf contributed to the economic prosperity of both China and the Persian Empire. The exchange of goods and the establishment of trade networks enhanced the commercial interests of both civilizations.

Zheng He's fleet sought alliances with local rulers, including Persian authorities, for mutual benefits such as trade privileges, protection, and cooperation against common threats. Zheng He's Chinese Muslim background and his connection with Persian Sufi Muslims likely facilitated diplomatic relations with the Persian Empire.

Cultural and Religious Exchanges

Zheng He's sevan voyages involved not only trade and diplomacy but also cultural and religious exchanges. The presence of Chinese Muslim crew members, along with Persian Sufi Muslims, likely fostered interactions and cultural understanding between the Chinese and Persian communities, contributing to the development of positive relationships.

The evidence supports the notion that Admiral Zheng He's voyages extended to the Persian Gulf, where he had interactions with the Persian Empire. Zheng He's presence in the region facilitated trade, diplomatic relations, political alliances, and cultural exchanges. Zheng He's Chinese Muslim background and his connection with Persian Sufi Muslims likely played a role in fostering these relationships. Further research and analysis of historical records can provide a more comprehensive understanding of Zheng He's presence in the Persian Gulf and his relationship with the Persian Empire





7. Sarathusa and sufi mystics

Perfumery's roots delve deep into the mystical and enchanting world of ancient Iran, where the art of fragrance was not merely a craft but a sacred rite intertwined with the very fabric of Zoroastrian ceremonies.

Picture yourself transported to the lush gardens of ancient Persia, where the air is alive with the intoxicating scents of jasmine, rose, and saffron.In the heart of Zoroastrian rituals, perfumes played a pivotal role, symbolizing purity, enlightenment, and divine connection.

The meticulous process of extracting floral essences was not merely a mundane task but a spiritual journey undertaken by skilled artisans known as "attar." These alchemists of aroma revered each blossom as a sacred offering, harnessing its essence to create fragrances that transcended the physical realm and reached into the realms of the divine.

The fragrance-making process was shrouded in mystery and reverence, mirroring the sacred rituals of the Zoroastrian faith. From the careful selection of flowers at their peak bloom to the delicate extraction methods passed down through generations, every step was infused with meaning and significance. Each drop of precious oil was believed to carry the essence of the divine, elevating the mundane act of anointing oneself with perfume into a sacred communion with the gods.

The resulting perfumes were not merely olfactory delights but vessels of spiritual enlightenment, used in ceremonies to purify the soul and invoke divine blessings. The heady aroma of these ancient Persian elixirs lingered not only on the skin but in the memory, weaving tales of love, devotion, and transcendence.As Persian culture flourished and spread its influence across the ancient world, so too did the art of perfumery, leaving an indelible mark on civilizations far and wide.

From the opulent courts of the East to the bustling markets of the Mediterranean, the fragrant legacy of ancient Iran continued to captivate and inspire, its echoes resonating through the annals of history to the present day.

So, the next time you dab on a drop of perfume, take a moment to immerse yourself in the ancient Iranian origins of this timeless art form. Let the intoxicating scents transport you to a realm where fragrances are not just fleeting pleasures but gateways to the divine, where every drop tells a story of reverence, ritual, and the eternal quest for beauty and enlightenment.


ZOROASTER

8. Iran and Sri Lanka stronger ties in today

Relationship between Iran and Sri Lanka Today

In recent years, Iran and Sri Lanka have been working tirelessly to enhance their bilateral ties across various sectors. Let's take a closer look at the cultural exchanges and collaborations that have been taking place between these two nations:

Diplomatic Visit and Warship Docking: Iranian Foreign Minister Hossein Amir-Abdollahian paid a high-profile visit to Sri Lanka, highlighting the importance both countries place on strengthening their relations. As a symbol of this commitment, two Iranian warships, IRINS Bushehr and Tonb, also docked at Colombo harbour. This visit signifies the deepening friendship and cooperation between Iran and Sri Lanka.

Cooperation in Politics, Economics, and Trade: During the visit, discussions focused on expanding cooperation in politics, economics, trade, and tourism . Sri Lanka praised Iran's economic and industrial strengths, expressing eagerness to welcome Iranian economic projects . Both nations are exploring avenues for expanded economic cooperation, highlighting the potential for mutually beneficial partnerships .

Support for Ceasefire and Palestinian State: Sri Lanka's President Ranil Wickremesinghe reiterated the country's support for a ceasefire in the ongoing Gaza conflict and proposed the possibility of establishing a Palestinian State within five years . Iran's government appreciated Sri Lanka's support for Palestinians and highlighted Sri Lanka's strategic position in the Indian Ocean . This shared commitment to peace and justice strengthens the bond between the two nations.

Strengthening Maritime Security: Iran and Sri Lanka are committed to ensuring freedom of navigation, particularly in the Persian Gulf and the Indian Ocean . Iran has demonstrated its dedication to safeguarding shipping in these regions by deploying two warships. This collaboration in maritime security further solidifies the relationship between the two countries.



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